

Sai P. Gourisankar, Ph.D.

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Academic Appointments

Assistant Member, Chemical Biology
Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center and Sloan Kettering Institute, USA incoming

Education and Training

NCI K99/R00 Postdoctoral Fellow 2026
Stanford Cancer Institute, USA
Ph.D., M.S., Chemical Engineering 2023
Stanford University, USA
M.P.P., Public Policy 2017
M.St., Global History 2016
University of Oxford, UK
B.S., Chemical Engineering 2015
B.A., Plan II Liberal Arts
University of Texas at Austin, USA

Research Interests

Development of novel chemical therapeutics, e.g., induced proximity modalities
Mechanisms of gene regulation in cancer

Grants

NCI Pathway to Independence Award for Outstanding Early-Stage Postdoctoral Researchers (K99/R00) (1K99CA296700-01) 2025
Ruth L. Kirschstein National Research Service Award (NIH 1F31HD103339-01) 2020
NSF Graduate Research Fellowship 2017

Highlighted Publications (*indicates co-first authorship)

S. Gourisankar*, A. Krokhutin*, W. Ji*, X. Liu, C-Y. Chang, S. H. Kim, Z. Li, W. Wenderski, J.M. Simanauskaite, H. Yang, H. Vogel, T. Zhang, N.S. Gray, G.R. Crabtree. Rewiring cancer drivers to activate apoptosis. *Nature*, **620**, 417-425 (2023).

Highlighted in:

- Phelan, J., Staudt, L. "Double-headed molecule activates cell-death pathways in cancer cells". *Nature*, 620, 285-286 (2023).
- Miura, G. "Linked to death". *Nat. Chem. Biol.*, 19, 1043 (2023).
- Kolata, G. "Flipping a switch and making cancers self-destruct". The New York Times. Published July 26, 2023.
- Dolgin, E. "Two-armed molecule flips switch on gene regulation". Cancer Discovery News in Brief. Published July 27, 2023.
- Wu, L.L. "'An unholy union': Stanford scientists create drug that flips cancer driver into killer". Endpoints News. Published July 27, 2023.

R.C. Sarott*, **S. Gourisankar***, B. Karim*, S.A. Nettles, H. Yang, B.G. Dwyer, J.M. Simauskaite, J. Tse, H. Abuzaid, A. Krokhutin, T. Zhang, S.M. Hinshaw, M.R. Green, G.R. Crabtree, N.S. Gray. Re-localizing transcriptional kinases to activate apoptosis. *Science*, **386**, ead15361 (2024).

Highlighted in:

- Atkinson, V. "Hijacking kinases to kill cancer". *Chemical & Engineering News*. Published October 14, 2024.

All Publications (*indicates co-first authorship)

1. M.N. Nix*, **S. Gourisankar***, S.A. Nettles, H. Yang, B.G. Dwyer, R.C. Sarott, H. Abuzaid, M.M. Martinez, N. Phillips, V. Cabaud, A. Hakobyan, V. Arakelov, G. Petrosyan, A. Davtyan, Y. Wang, J.M. Simanauskaite, B.A. Romero, H.M. Jones, A. Krokhotin, T.N. Lowensohn, L. Chen, C. Low, H. Vogel, M.M. Davis, D. Fernandez, T. Zhang, M.R. Green, S.M. Hinshaw, N.S. Gray, G.R. Crabtree. A bivalent molecular glue linking lysine acetyltransferases to oncogene-induced cell death. *Cell*. (2026). doi: 10.1016/j.cell.2026.06.037
2. Yang, H., Bowman, K., Ji, W. **Gourisankar, S.**, Yang, Z., Dwyer, B. Wang, Y. Sainz, T., Thakkar, B., Wilson, A., Marszalek, E., Hinshaw, S.M., Zhang, T., Liu, X., Romero, B., Forrest, I., Simanauskaite, J., Sarott, R.C., Karim, B., Krokhotin, A., Nettles, S., Flowers, C.R., Cerhan, J.R., Koff, J.L., Patel, S., Vega, F., Li, X., Kundu, S., Crabtree, G.R., Gray, N.S., Green, M.R.. Rewiring BCL6 with Transcriptional/epigenetic Chemical Inducers of Proximity Unveils Targetable Plasticity in Large B Cell Lymphoma. (2026) (*in revision*), preprint at: <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.6946712>
3. X. Zhu, W.S. Byun, D.E. Pienkowska, K.T. Nguyen, M. Wang, S.A. Nettles, **S. Gourisankar**, N.A. Phillips, J. Gerhartz, Q. Geng, T. Qiu, J. Zhong, Z. Jiang, R.C. Sarott, S. M. Hinshaw, T. Zhang, L.D. Attardi, R.P. Nowak, N.S. Gray. Activating p53^{Y220C} with a mutant-specific small molecule. *Nat. Comm.* (2026). doi: 10.1038/s41467-026-72165-6
4. M.J. Bond, R.P. Golden, G. DiGiovanni, B. Howard, R.C. Sarott, B.A. Karim, **S. Gourisankar**, G. Alexe, K. Ross, N.S. Gray, K. Stegmaier. Rewiring the fusion oncoprotein EWS/FLI in Ewing sarcoma with bivalent small molecules. *J. Am. Chem. Soc.* (2025). doi: 10.1021/jacs.5c05634
5. **S. Gourisankar***, S.A. Nettles*, W. Wenderski, J.A. Paulo, S.H. Kim, K.C. Roepke, C. Ellis, H.Z. Abuzaid, S.P. Gygi, G.R. Crabtree. Synaptic activity causes minute-scale changes to BAF complex composition and function" *Molecular Cell* **85**, 12, 2374-89 (2025).
6. R.C. Sarott*, **S. Gourisankar***, B. Karim*, S.A. Nettles, H. Yang, B.G. Dwyer, J.M. Simanauskaite, J. Tse, H. Abuzaid, A. Krokhotin, T. Zhang, S.M. Hinshaw, M.R. Green, G.R. Crabtree, N.S. Gray. Re-localizing transcriptional kinases to activate apoptosis. *Science*, **386**, eadl5361 (2024).
7. **S. Gourisankar**, A. Krokhotin, W. Wenderski, G.R. Crabtree. Context-specific functions of chromatin remodellers in development and disease. *Nature Rev. Genetics*, **25**, 340-361 (2024).
8. **S. Gourisankar***, A. Krokhotin*, W. Ji*, X. Liu, C-Y. Chang, S. H. Kim, Z. Li, W. Wenderski, J.M. Simanauskaite, H. Yang, H. Vogel, T. Zhang, N.S. Gray, G.R. Crabtree. Rewiring cancer drivers to activate apoptosis. *Nature*, **620**, 417-425 (2023).
9. E.J. Chory, J.G. Kirkland, C-Y. Chang, V.D. D'Andrea, **S. Gourisankar**, E.C. Dykhuizen, G.R. Crabtree. Chemical inhibitors of a selective SWI/SNF function synergize with ATR inhibition in cancer cell killing. *ACS Chem. Biol.*, **15**, 1685-1696 (2020).
10. E.Y. Son*, A. Krokhotin*, **S. Gourisankar**, C-Y. Chang, G.R. Crabtree. *ARID1B* is a dosage-sensitive regulator of PRC distribution and Hox gene regulation in human neural progenitors. *ResearchSquare* (2021) (*in revision*): preprint doi: 10.21203/rs.3.rs-959800/v1.
11. R.J. Stover*, E. Moaseri*, **S. Gourisankar**, N. Rahbar, B. Changalvaie, M. Iqbal, T. Truskett, K. Johnston. Formation of small gold nanoparticle chains with high NIR extinction through bridging with calcium ions. *Langmuir*, **32**, 1127-1138 (2016).
12. R.J. Stover, A.K. Murthy, G.D. Nie, **S. Gourisankar**, B.J. Dear, T.M. Truskett, K.V. Sokolov, K.P. Johnston. Quenched assembly of NIR-active gold nanoclusters capped with strongly bound ligands by tuning particle charge via pH and salinity. *J. Phys Chem C.*, **118**, 14291-14298 (2014).
13. A.K. Murthy, R.J. Stover, A.U. Borwankar, G.D. Nie, **S. Gourisankar**, T.M. Truskett, K.V. Sokolov, K.P. Johnston. Equilibrium gold nanoclusters quenched with biodegradable polymers. *ACS Nano.*, **7**, 239-251 (2013).
14. A.K. Murthy, R.J. Stover, W.G. Hardin, R. Schramm, G.D. Nie, **S. Gourisankar**, K.V. Sokolov, K.P. Johnston. Charged gold nanoparticles with essentially zero serum protein adsorption in undiluted fetal bovine serum. *J. Am. Chem. Soc.*, **135**, 7799-7802 (2013).
15. N.W. Smith, **S.P. Gourisankar**, J.L. Montchamp, S.V. Dzyuba. Silver-free synthesis of nitrate-containing room-temperature ionic liquids. *New J. Chem.*, **35**, 909-914 (2011).

Patents and Applications

G.R. Crabtree, N. Gray, **S. Gourisankar**, *et al.* Heterobifunctional compounds and methods of use thereof. WO/2025/007026, published February 2025.

G.R. Crabtree, N. Gray, **S. Gourisankar**, *et al.* Compositions, systems, and methods for modulating a target gene. WO/2023/215311, published September 2023.

G.R. Crabtree, **S. Gourisankar**, *et al.* Modulation of gene expression via transcription factor-chemical induced proximity (TF-CIP). WO/2022/098989, published December 2022.

Selected Presentations

Drug Discovery Chemistry Spotlight Session, San Diego, CA <i>invited talk</i>	Apr 2026
Genentech Physiological Chemistry, San Francisco, CA, <i>invited talk</i>	Oct 2025
European Society for Hematology, Estoril, Portugal, <i>invited talk</i>	Oct 2025
MIT-Broad Institute Chemical Biology SuperGroup, Boston, MA, <i>invited talk</i>	Oct 2025
Center for Targeted Protein Degradation, Dundee, U.K., <i>invited talk</i>	June 2025
Max Planck Institute for Biomedical Research, Heidelberg, Germany, <i>invited talk</i>	June 2025
Synthesis Workshop, online https://shorturl.at/6Fsp4 <i>invited talk</i>	May 2025
AACR, Major Symposia: Harnessing Induced Proximity, Chicago, IL, <i>invited talk</i>	Apr 2025
American Society for Biochemistry and Molecular Biology, Chicago, IL, <i>invited talk</i>	Apr 2025
Prof. K. Shokat Group Seminar, UCSF, San Francisco, CA, <i>invited talk</i>	Mar 2025
Experimental Therapeutics, MD Anderson Cancer Ctr., Houston, TX, <i>invited talk</i>	Nov 2024
Prof. R. Tijan and Prof. X. Darzaq Joint Group Seminar, Berkeley, CA, <i>invited talk</i>	Aug 2024
American Chemical Society National Meeting Fall 2024, Denver, CO	Aug 2024
Fragile Nucleosome Seminar, online https://youtu.be/-eNI-ByXB-E , <i>invited talk</i>	Apr 2024
Proximity-Inducing Pharmacology, IRB Biomed Conference, Barcelona, Spain	May 2023
Steel Symposium for Developmental Oncology, Memorial Sloan, New York, NY	May 2023
Dana Farber Targeted Protein Degradation Seminar, Cambridge, MA, <i>invited talk</i>	Jan 2023
American Institute of Chemical Engineers Nat'l Meeting, Atlanta, GA, <i>invited talk</i>	Nov 2014

Teaching Experience

University of Chicago Chicago, IL USA	2025
<i>Guest Speaker, Cancer Biology Seminar</i>	
Stanford University Stanford, CA USA	2020-2022
<i>Instructor, INDE 209: Analysis of Life Science Companies</i>	
Stanford University Stanford, CA USA	2020-2021
<i>Teaching Assistant, CHEMENG 355: Advanced Biochemical Engineering</i>	
Stanford Prison Education Project, San Bruno Jail San Bruno, CA USA	2018-2019
<i>Lecturer, Genetics and CRISPR/Cas9</i>	
University of Texas at Austin Austin, TX USA	2013
<i>Tutor, CHE 317: Introduction to Chemical Engineering</i>	

Trainees Mentored

At the Stanford Cancer Institute, I have mentored:

three graduate students (2 in Chemistry, 1 in Chemical Systems Biology), and one research assistant.

At Stanford University, I have mentored:

two research assistants and two undergraduates. One won the Barry M. Goldwater Scholarship.

Academic Service

Reviewer for <i>ACS Chem. Biol.</i> , <i>Nature Genetics</i> , <i>Nature Communications</i>	2022-present
Stanford Office of Global Scholarships Stanford, CA USA <i>Interviewer, Rhodes and Marshall Scholarship Candidates</i>	2019-present
Stanford Department of Chemical Engineering Stanford, CA USA <i>Chair, Convocation and Research Symposium</i>	2018-2020

Selected Honors and Awards

Rhodes Scholarship	2015
Astronaut Foundation Scholarship (national research award)	2014
Barry M. Goldwater Scholarship	2013

Industry Experience

Co-founder and Advisor, Shenandoah Therapeutics Woodside, CA USA	2023-present
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